

THE SOMETHING BLUE MURDER · SOLUTION · OPEN LAST

STOP.



Open only after everyone has voted.

This file names the culprit. Hosts: don't open, don't print-preview. Guest of Honor: when every ballot is in, turn to page 4 and read Script 5 aloud.

The Something Blue Murder

A Cozy Bachelorette & Bridal Shower Murder Mystery · 6–14 players

THE CULPRIT

Finley Marsh, the photographer

How: alone in the tea room for “teacup photos,” Finley took Cece’s heart drops from Cece’s handbag and emptied the whole bottle into the empty blue teacup at about 3:14. Emerson poured the chamomile on top at 3:30.

Why: Cece had discovered that Finley was selling clients’ private wedding photos to the gossip pages and planned to tell everyone on Sunday.

The clue chain (6 steps)

STEP	SOURCE	WHAT IT PROVES
1	Evidence #4 + #5	The drops went into the empty cup between 3:00 and 3:20. The cup was clean and dry at 3:00 (E4). The doctor found Cece’s own heart drops dried on the bottom, added at least ten minutes before the 3:30 pour (E5). So it was not the honey, the teapot, the foxglove, or Emerson’s pouring.
2	Evidence #7 + #8	At 3:12 the cup was still empty and dry; at 3:16 Cece’s amber bottle stood beside the saucer (E7). That bottle had been in Cece’s handbag pocket (E8). So the drops went in between 3:12 and 3:20, while someone stood in the tea room photographing the cup. Dakota was outside in the flower bed in every photo.
3	Booklets 10, 11, 12, 13 (Round 1)	Everyone else in the core cast was elsewhere: the Guest of Honor and Blair were together at the dock (10 R1, 11 R1); Reese and Emerson were together in the kitchen (12 R1, 13 R1).
4	Booklets 12 + 13 (Round 2), Evidence #11, booklet 15 (Round 2)	The photographer was Finley. At 3:05 Finley asked Emerson to keep the tea room empty for teacup photos (13 R2, 12 R2); the sign was borrowed at 3:08 “for photos” (E11). The garden doors stayed shut until just before tea (15 R2), so nobody else slipped in.
5	Evidence #12 + booklets 10 (Round 2), 11 (Round 3), 15 (Round 3)	Finley lied. At 3:27 Finley came out of the garden doors claiming to have come up from the boathouse (E12, 11 R3, 15 R3), but the Guest of Honor and Blair had been beside the boathouse since 3:05 and nobody came near it (10 R2, 11 R2).
6	Evidence #9 + #10, booklet 13 (Round 3)	The cover-up and the motive. The empty bottle was wiped and wrapped in a gray lens cloth that isn’t the inn’s (E9, 13 R3). Cece was about to expose whoever sold clients’ private photos taken from spots where only the hired photographer may stand (E10), and Finley is Cece’s hired photographer.

Key evidence numbers for scoring: E4, E5, E7, E8, E9, E10, E11, E12.

Why Not the Others?

12 SUSPECTS CLEARED

SUSPECT	WHY THEY LOOKED SUSPICIOUS	WHY IT WASN'T THEM
11 Blair Ashdown	Fired by Cece in 2016 (E1); unpacked the cup.	At the dock with the Guest of Honor 3:05–3:25 (10 R1, 11 R1); the cup was clean when they left (E4).
12 Reese Calloway	Lost a \$4,000 deposit (E2); brought honey.	In the kitchen with Emerson 3:00–3:30; the honey jar was clean (E5).
13 Emerson Pryce	Cece's column hurt the inn (E3); poured the tea.	In the kitchen with Reese; the drops dried in the empty cup long before the pour (E5).
15 Dakota Lane	Unpaid rush fee; foxglove in the vases (E6).	No plant was involved (E5); in the flower bed in every photo (E7).
16 Kendall Brooks	Dropped from Cece's list; amber glue bottle.	Fitting room with Peyton; the bottle in E9 is labeled for Cece.
17 Remy Okafor	Removed from Cece's weddings.	On the terrace with Hayden; passed through the tea room at about 2:54, before the cup was unpacked.
18 Tatum Reyes	Rival planner with a draft contract.	On the ferry until 3:15, then the dock and lobby.
19 Shiloh Park	Cece took credit for Shiloh's designs; knew the drops.	Upstairs with Cece until 3:28.
20 Marlowe Gray	Threatened with a lawsuit; carries gray cloths.	In the library; Marlowe's cloths are monogrammed, E9's is plain.
21 Peyton Lowe	Fee argument; peeked in the handbag at 2:51.	Took nothing (the bottle was still there); fitting room 3:00–3:30.
22 Hayden Cruz	Replaced at the wedding; "Sleepy Lavender" syrup.	On the terrace with Remy; the drops were Cece's own heart drops (E5).
23 Lennox Bell	Owed Cece rising referral fees; sleeping tablets.	On the ferry until 3:15, then the dock and lobby; tablets still sealed.

Optional characters (16–23) are cleared by their own alibis; the case never depends on them.

READ ALOUD

Thank you, everyone. Here is the truth about the something blue teacup. At three o'clock, Blair and I set my grandmother's cup on the side table, clean and dry. The doctor tells us that Cece's own heart drops dried on the bottom of that empty cup at least ten minutes before the tea was poured, so the drops went in before twenty past three. At twelve minutes past, the photos on that memory card show the cup still empty; at sixteen minutes past, Cece's amber bottle stands right beside it.

Who was in the tea room taking those photos? Blair and I were at the dock. Reese and Emerson were together in the kitchen. Dakota was in the flower bed outside the window in every single photo, and the old garden doors never creaked until just before tea. At five past three, one person asked Emerson to keep the tea room empty for teacup photos, and borrowed the Private Session sign. And at twenty-seven minutes past, that same person stepped out of the garden doors and told Blair and me they had just come up from the boathouse, where Blair and I had been standing the whole time.

The culprit is Finley Marsh. Finley had been selling Cece's clients' private wedding photos to the gossip pages, and on Sunday Cece was going to tell everyone. So Finley emptied Cece's drops into my teacup, wrapped the bottle in a lens cloth and hid it in Dakota's flowers. Finley, please take a bow. And everyone else: thank you for the best celebration a Guest of Honor could ask for. Now, let's raise our mocktails to something old, something new, something borrowed... and something blue.

THEN

Hand back to the host to score the ballots (page 5) and give out the awards.

BALLOT LINE	CORRECT ANSWER	POINTS
Who did it?	Finley Marsh	3
How?	Emptied Cece's own heart drops into the empty blue teacup while alone in the tea room taking photos (any answer naming the drops and the empty teacup).	2
Why?	To stop Cece from revealing that Finley sold clients' private wedding photos (any answer about the leaked photos).	2
Key evidence	One point each for E4, E5, E7, E8, E9, E10, E11 or E12	max 3
Best possible score		10

Half points

- "How" that names the teacup but not the drops: 1 point.
- "Why" that says "Cece was going to expose a secret" without the photos: 1 point.

Awards (file 34)

- **Best Detective:** highest ballot score. Ties go to the most evidence numbers, then to the Guest of Honor's choice.
- **Best Performance:** vote by applause. Finley is eligible, especially if nobody guessed.
- **Best Dressed:** vote by applause.

THANK YOU

We hope The Something Blue Murder made a happy memory for your Guest of Honor.
Questions? hello@clueandcandlegames.com · Clue & Candle Games